

EPISODE 11 (SESSION 1)

Here I Am

PRIMARY TEXT: GENESIS 18, 21–22

*What is your greatest dream? Salem—peace.
That we could all do this, just like this, forever in eternity.*

This episode pulls on two different strings within my heart. The conviction of Abraham's radical hospitality and the simple truth that God is *always* there. Yet, I'm realizing those two things can, and should, be intimately connected; they're not two separate points or avenues of discussion. Isn't God's constant, intimate presence the greatest act of radical hospitality?

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radical hospitality?**

If I believe God is always here, and trust that He is with me in my best and worst moments, shouldn't that impact the way I view the world and the people I meet within it? Shouldn't being in relationship with a God who sees me and is always there, instill in me a desire to model that for others? To be different—set apart?

I wonder what would happen if humanity lived more like Abraham in these chapters? Human, yes, but showing radical hospitality, filled with *chutzpah*, yet vulnerable enough to truly see and be seen?

How would the world look different? How would the world feel different?

How would the world BE different—if humanity spent its efforts on making sure there were enough cups and enough tea to go around, even for the strangers who arrive at the door uninvited, rather than their own desires and security?

What would happen if we asked God to help us see one another as He does?

Took on their fears, their pains, their sorrows as Jesus does for us.

I wonder what would happen?

I wonder what would happen if each of us worked to embody the character of God every day? If we followed through on our end of the promise to be a blessing to all nations, to all people?

**What would happen
if each of us worked
to embody the
character of God...**

Marty shares the story of his first encounter with Hadijah in Israel, and how, when asked what her greatest dream was, she replied with *peace*. That we could all sit in the good company of one another, drinking warm tea, welcoming family and stranger, forever.

What does, or could, this look like in our world? For you?

I have a cupboard overflowing with mugs in my house. Yes, I do love fun mugs, but the reason for the growing collection is because of my own experience with Hadijah. Welcomed by a total stranger, served the most delicious of teas and softest of breads, and wanting to taste and smell that peace forever.

As my mug collection grows, it serves as my reminder to live a life of radical hospitality. To be a place of shade and rest for those wandering in the desert or those just passing through—

The door always open and never in fear of running out of cups.



PRAYER

*Heavenly Father,
Thank you for being a God who sees me.
Who will never abandon me.
When I am joyful, you are there.
When I am grieving, you are there.
When I am angry, you are there.
When I am at peace, you are there.*

*In my greatest moments of radical hospitality
And my darkest moments
when it is so hard to feel and be seen,
in my chutzpah, and in my greatest time of need,
may I always remember that you are here.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 11

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

How could you meditate over these parts of the Story? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

In what ways does your community show radical hospitality? Or how could it? What reminders could you leave for yourself and those in your community?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from the reminder that God is always there—that God sees them and knows them? How can you disciple them to recognize the presence of God nearby? How can you disciple them in a way of radical hospitality?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About the treatment and role of Hagar? The promises of God and the call to show radical hospitality to everyone? What might this speak to in our current world and culture? The struggle is real—it's good!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part of creating space for God, He will fill it, because He truly does see us!** He is near, always. We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all. How have you, or could you, create a space that God can fill? Even if it feels a bit different than we'd hoped or planned. You are a part of the promise to God, and creating a space is a way of making ourselves vulnerable to God—willing and asking to be seen.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world, and they need the blessings and care of people like you. In what ways could you come alongside young adults to show them radical hospitality? The easy answer may be food! Coffee, an open invitation to visit, to call, to reach out. How might this bring them closer to God and how can it show them that He is always near and sees them?

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This may be about what we do at work—but it's also about those we interact with every day. Do we carry Abraham's covenant to bless the world with us always, or only when it is convenient or safe? Do we hold space for God to grow near us in our workplace—the office, the home, the shop, the store, etc.? Do we bring radical hospitality when we can to our workplace, or do we clock in and out without making eye contact? **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters to the Kingdom!***